



"Dolaidh, can you hear me?" Sevastyan asked.

"I can hear you," Dolaidh said.

"I'm trying to trace the call, Tisket, just keep him talking," Gibraltar muttered. "If I can just use Maarika's program to triangulate the signal..."

"Dolaidh said he's sorry, but doesn't speak dirtbag," Tisket said into the phone.

"Oh, clever, very clever," Sevastyan said. "You must be the pooka. Delightful. Now, Dolaidh, I need you to listen very carefully. Are you listening?"

Dolaidh sounded strained when he answered. "Tell him I'm listening."

"Keep him talking, Tisk. Just keep him talking," Gibraltar said. "I've almost got him."

"He says 'ew, whatever,'" Tisket said.

Sevastyan laughed. It was unpleasant and made Tisket's skin crawl. "Dolaidh, Dolaidh, Dolaidh," he said, with a *tsking* sound after. "I knew you were coming for the coin. I've been watching your team since the Art Institute incident two years ago in San Francisco. I've watched all the surveillance videos. I even had the pleasure of watching that little antiques job in Bangor live over the surveillance feed. Excellent work there."

Ranveig shouted again in the distance, immediately followed by a rapid sequence of clangs and crashes. Maarika still stood inside the vault, watching the phone in Tisket's hand with a growing look of horror. Tisket felt a weird frisson of energy, then the vault door began to snap closed. She corkscrewed her body out of the way, throwing herself away from the door and into the bathroom, dropping the phone onto the floor. As the phone hit marble, the speaker knocked on, and Sevastyan's voice filled the room.

"This was all by design, my greedy clurichaun *znakómyj*," the baron said. "I learned what you wanted, how you went after it, and I created this scenario just to get your mofley here. Zhanna worked very hard on the vault. You should not have taken my 1800 Draped Bust Dollar, Dolaidh. I liked that coin. I won it at the Preakness several years ago. The bust on the obverse resembles my sister, as well, and I have a variable affection for my sister."

"Tell him we'll give the coin back," Gibraltar says into Tisket's ear, his words over-run by Dolaidh's immediate "Don't!"